



Learning that leads to action.

Psychological Safety is a Pre-Req



Learning Outcomes

- ❑ Define psychological safety and explain its impact on performance
- ❑ Identify the 4 stages of psychological safety
- ❑ Recognize signs of safety vs. danger on your teams
- ❑ Begin preparing for check-ins that invite honest feedback and engagement





Agenda



15 min	Welcome & Intro to Psychological Safety
15 min	4 Stages of Psychological Safety
18 min	Accountability & Building Psychological Safety
10 min	Personal Reflection
2 min	Next Steps



Poll: Which would you choose?

Hospital A

- **Rating:** 4.9 / 5.0
- **Org Culture:** 4.8 / 5.0
- **Avg monthly reported errors:** 2

Hospital B

- **Rating:** 4.8 / 5.0
- **Org Culture:** 4.8 / 5.0
- **Avg monthly reported errors:** 6



What is Psychological Safety?





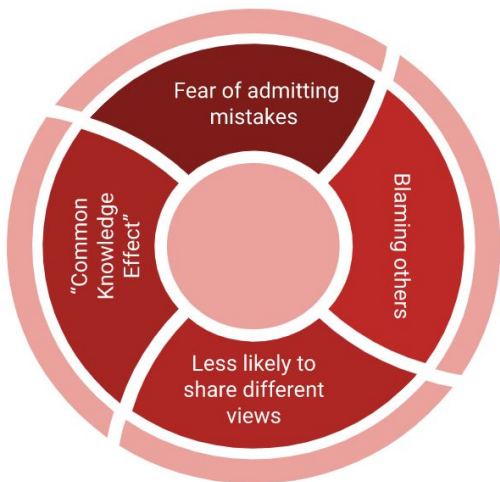
What is Psychological Safety?

A shared belief held by members of a team that the team is safe for interpersonal risk-taking.

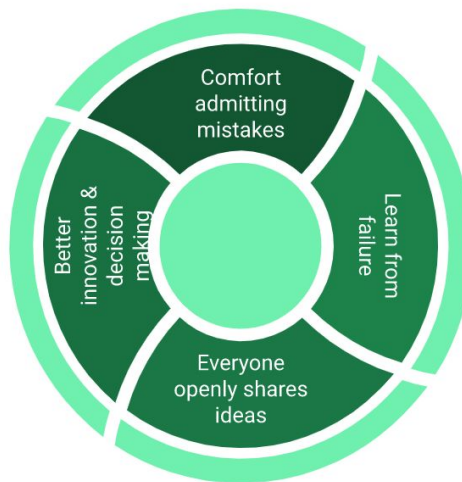
- ❑ No one will be punished or humiliated for speaking up with ideas, questions, concerns, or mistakes
- ❑ People are comfortable being (and expressing) themselves

Psychological Safety vs. Danger

Psychological
Danger

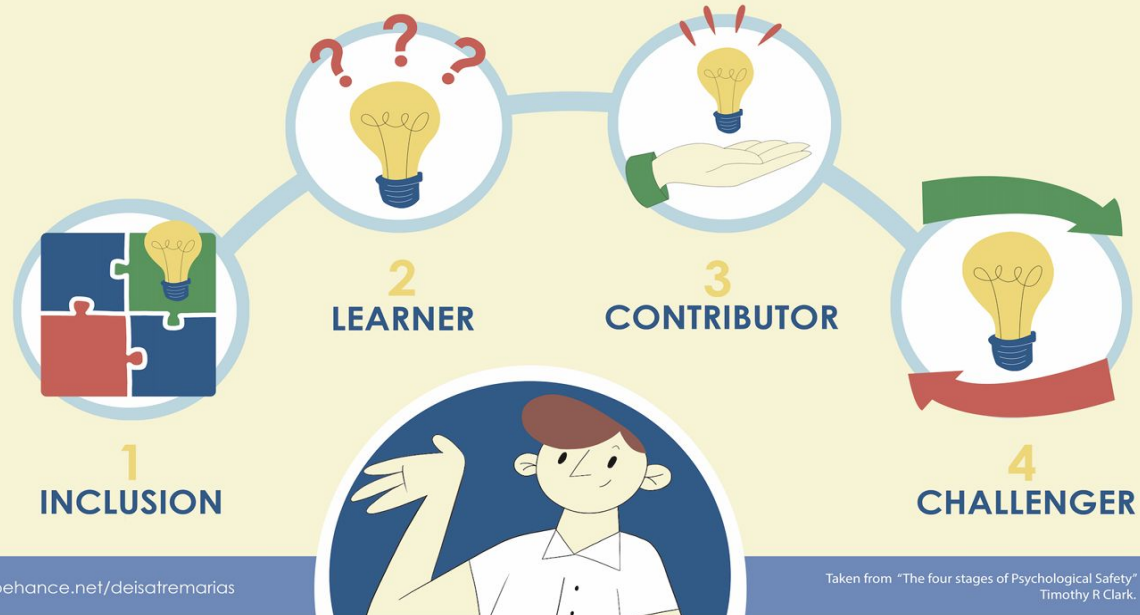


Psychological
Safety



When have you experienced aspects of Psychological Danger and Psychological Safety? What was that like for you, and how did it affect you/your team?

THE 4 STAGES OF PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY





4 Stages of Psychological Safety

- ❑ **Inclusion Safety:** members feel safe to belong to the team. They are comfortable being present, do not feel excluded, and feel like they are wanted and appreciated.
- ❑ **Learner Safety:** members are able to learn through asking questions. Team members here may be able to experiment, make (and admit) small mistakes, and ask for help
- ❑ **Contributor Safety:** members feel safe to contribute their own ideas, without fear of embarrassment or ridicule. This is a more challenging state, because volunteering your own ideas can increase the psychosocial vulnerability of team members
- ❑ **Challenger Safety:** members can question others' (including those in authority) ideas or suggest significant changes to ideas, plans, or ways of working.



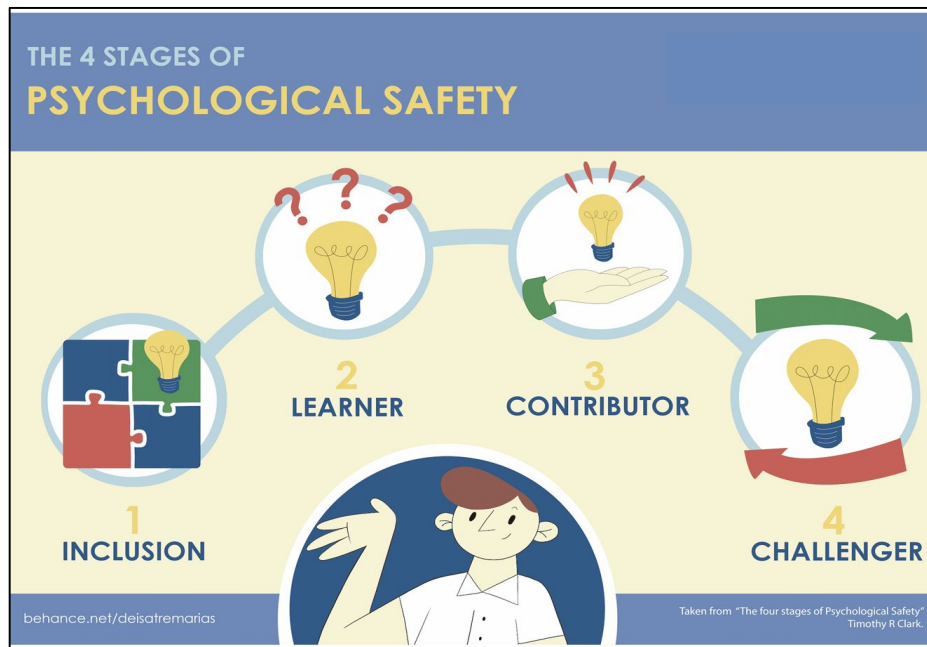
4 Stages of Psychological Safety

Self:

- ❑ What stage(s) of psychological safety do you operate in here at Saga?
- ❑ Which stage(s) are difficult for you to operate in & why?

Team:

- ❑ Which stage(s) do you think your team operates in?
- ❑ Which stage(s) are difficult for your team and why?





4 Stages of Psychological Safety

Scenario 1: A team member is willing to ask questions and share their ideas, but they feel self-conscious about making mistakes or being seen as incompetent. They tend to seek approval from their manager before taking action.

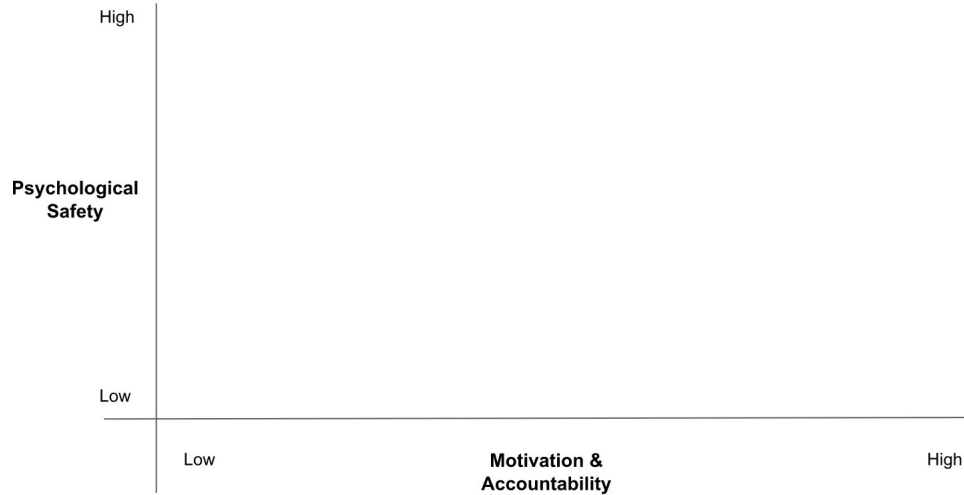
Scenario 2: A new team member is nervous about speaking up in meetings because they are unsure if their ideas will be valued. They tend to stay quiet and avoid expressing their opinions.

Scenario 3: A team member feels empowered to challenge the status quo and suggest innovative solutions. They are not afraid to speak up, even if their ideas are controversial or unpopular. They trust their manager and teammates to provide honest feedback and support their efforts to drive change.

Scenario 4: A team member is comfortable expressing their opinions and taking calculated risks. They trust their manager and teammates to provide support and constructive feedback, and they feel confident in their abilities.



Accountability & Psychological Safety



How do you build psychological safety?





Case Study



Uli is a long-time DoP known for their strong instructional knowledge and systems thinking. For the past two years, they've led team XYZ, which supports implementation and quality across multiple school sites.

Uli sets a high bar for themselves and others, and the team has historically respected their expertise. But in recent months, Uli has become noticeably less open to feedback, quick to dismiss ideas they see as “off track,” and unwilling to engage with viewpoints that challenge their own.

In a recent team meeting, Uli shut down a suggestion from an experienced team member and later criticized that person in a side conversation with others. Several teammates had thought the suggestion was thoughtful, data-informed, and aligned with the team's goals. Since then, fewer people have spoken up with ideas or questions.

The final proposal submitted to leadership reflected Uli's direction, but it was ultimately declined due to a lack of creativity and cross-functional input.

Case Study



1. What behaviors do you see that reflect psychological safety?
2. What behaviors may signal that psychological safety is lacking in the scenario?
3. What zone is this team operating in? Apathy, Comfort, Anxiety, Learning?
4. Why is psychological safety so important? What difference does it make in a team? What have you seen on your team(s)?



Building/Nurturing Psychological Safety

- ❑ Frame the work as a learning problem, not an execution problem
- ❑ Acknowledge your own fallibility
- ❑ Model curiosity and ask lots of questions

How do you build psychological safety?





Personal Reflection

- When have you felt most comfortable sharing honest feedback with a manager, colleague, or direct report?
- When do you think others feel most comfortable sharing openly with you?
- **Managers:** What might a more feedback-friendly check-in look like for you and your direct report?
- **As we prepare for Quarterly Check-ins, what *specific actions* can you take before or during your check-ins to create psychological safety for your direct reports?**

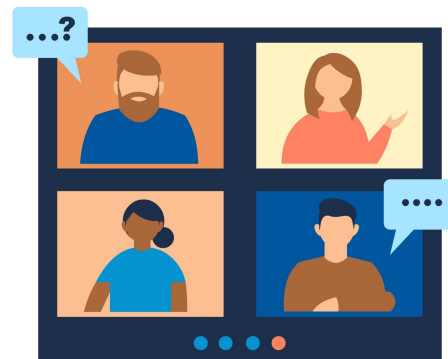


Breakout Rooms

Share one insight from your reflection.

Ask your partner:

- What might make that difficult to implement?
- How will you know it's working?





What's Next?

For you:

- ❑ Post session materials
- ❑ Grow @ Saga session on Emotional Intelligence on September 4th

From you:

- ❑ Complete feedback survey



Thank you.



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What Impacts Psychological Safety?

Punishment
Culture

Not Allowing
Conflict

Communication
Style Issues

Blame Culture

Not Embracing
Feedback

